

Digestion

Food provides the body with nutrients. But releasing those nutrients from food requires a process called digestion. First, the food has to be cut up and churned into small particles. This makes it easier for enzymes to work on the complex chemicals that make up food and split them into substances that can be used by the body. All of this happens inside the digestive system.

DIGESTIVE SYSTEM

The digestive system consists of a long, muscular tube called the digestive tract, which runs from the mouth to the anus. It has several distinct regions, including the esophagus, stomach, small intestine, and large intestine—each with its own tasks. Other organs that help digestion, such as the gall bladder and pancreas, add digestive chemicals at various points along the way.

WOW!

During an average lifetime, a person will eat their way through, and digest, at least 20 tons of food.

